

Girimānanda Sutta

Girimānandasutta (AN 10.60)

Ekam samayaṃ bhagavā sāvatthiyaṃ viharati jetavane anāthapiṇḍikassa ārāme.
Tena kho pana samayena āyasmā girimānando ābādhiko hoti dukkhito bālāhagilāno.
Atha kho āyasmā ānando yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamitvā
bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. Ekamantaṃ nisinno kho āyasmā
ānando bhagavantam etadavoca:

At one time the Blessed One was staying near Sāvatthī in Jeta's Grove, Anāthapiṇḍika's Monastery. At that time the Venerable Girimānanda was sick, suffering, gravely ill. Then the Venerable Ānanda went to the Blessed One, paid respects, and sat down to one side. Sitting there to one side, the Venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One:

“Āyasmā, bhante, girimānando ābādhiko hoti dukkhito bālāhagilāno. Sādhū, bhante, bhagavā yenāyasmā girimānando tenupasaṅkamatū anukampaṃ upādāyā”ti.

“Venerable Girimānanda, bhante, is sick, suffering, gravely ill. It would be good, bhante, if the Blessed One would visit Venerable Girimānanda out of compassion.”

“Sace kho tvaṃ, ānanda, girimānandassa bhikkhuno dasa saññā bhāseyyāsi, ṭhānaṃ kho panetaṃ vijjati yaṃ girimānandassa bhikkhuno dasa saññā sutvā so ābādhō ṭhānaso paṭippassambheyya.

“If you, Ānanda, were to speak to the monk Girimānanda about the ten perceptions (*saññā*), it is possible that upon hearing these ten perceptions, his illness would immediately subside.

Katamā dasa? Aniccasaññā, anattasaññā, asubhasaññā, ādīnavasaññā, pahānasaññā, virāgasaññā, nirodhasaññā, sabbaloke anabhiratasaññā, sabbasaṅkhāresu anicchāsaññā, ānāpānassati.

What ten? The perception of impermanence (*aniccasaññā*), the perception of non-self (*anattasaññā*), the perception of the unattractiveness of the body (*asubhasaññā*), the perception of danger (*ādīnavasaññā*), the perception of abandoning (*pahānasaññā*), the perception of dispassion (*virāgasaññā*), the perception of cessation (*nirodhasaññā*), the perception of non-attachment to the entire world (*sabbaloke anabhiratasaññā*), the perception of the unsatisfactoriness of all conditioned formations (*sabbasaṅkhāresu anicchāsaññā*), and mindfulness of breathing (*ānāpānassati*).

Katamā cānanda, aniccasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā rukkhamaṭṭhagato vā suññāgāragato vā iti paṭisañcikkhati: ‘rūpaṃ aniccaṃ, vedanā aniccā, saññā aniccā, saṅkhārā aniccā, viññāṇaṃ aniccaṃ’ti. Iti imesu pañcasu upādānakkhandhesu aniccānupassī viharati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, aniccasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of impermanence? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, reflects in this way: ‘Physical form (*rūpa*) is impermanent, sensation (*vedanā*) is impermanent, perception (*saññā*) is impermanent, mental reaction (*saṅkhāra*) is impermanent, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) is impermanent.’ In this way, he lives observing impermanence in these five aggregates of clinging (*upādānakkhandha*). This, Ānanda, is called the perception of impermanence.

Katamā cānanda, anattasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā rukkhamaṭṭhagato vā suññāgāragato vā iti paṭisañcikkhati: ‘cakkhu anattā, rūpā anattā, sotaṃ anattā, saddā anattā, ghāṇaṃ anattā, gandhā anattā, jivhā anattā, rasā anattā, kāyā anattā, phoṭṭhabbā anattā, mano anattā, dhammā anattā’ti. Iti imesu chasu ajjhattikabāhiresu āyatanesu anattānupassī viharati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, anattasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of non-self? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, reflects in this way: ‘The eye is non-self, physical forms (*rūpa*) are non-self, the ear is non-self, sounds are non-self, the nose is non-self, smells are non-self, the tongue is non-self, tastes are non-self, the body is non-self, tangible objects are non-self, the mind is non-self, mental objects (*dhamma*) are non-self.’ In this way, he lives observing non-self in these six internal and external sense fields (*āyatana*). This, Ānanda, is called the perception of non-self.

Katamā cānanda, asubhasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu imameva kāyaṃ uddhaṃ pādatalā adho kesamatthakā tacapariyantaṃ pūraṃ nānāppakārassa asucino paccavekkhati: ‘atthi imasmiṃ kāye kesā lomā nakhā dantā taco, maṃsaṃ nhāru atthi atthimiñjaṃ vakkāṃ, hadayaṃ yakaṇaṃ kilomakaṃ pihakaṃ papphāsaṃ, antaṃ antaguṇaṃ udariyaṃ karīsaṃ, pittaṃ semhaṃ pubbo lohitaṃ sedo medo, assu vasā kheḷo siṅghāṇikā lasikā muttan’ti. Iti imasmiṃ kāye asubhānupassī viharati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, asubhasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of the unattractiveness of the body? Here, Ānanda, a monk observes this very body upward from the soles of the feet and downward from the crown of the head, enclosed by skin, full of many kinds of impurities: ‘In this body there are head hairs, body hairs, nails, teeth, skin, flesh, tendons, bones, bone marrow, kidneys, heart, liver, diaphragm, spleen, lungs, large intestines, small intestines, undigested food, feces, bile, phlegm, pus, blood, sweat, fat, tears, skin-grease, saliva, mucus, fluid in the joints, and urine.’ In this way, he lives observing the unattractiveness of this body. This, Ānanda, is called the perception of the unattractiveness of the body.

Katamā cānanda, ādīnavasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā iti paṭisañcikkhati: ‘bahudukkho kho ayaṃ kāyo bahuādīnavo. Iti imasmim kāye vividhā ābādhā uppajjanti, seyyathidaṃ— cakkhurogo sotarogo ghānarogo jivhārogo kāyarogo sīsarogo kaṇṇarogo mukharogo dantarogo oṭṭharogo kāso sāso pināso dāho jaro kucchirogo mucchā pakkhandikā sūlā visūcikā kuṭṭhaṃ gaṇḍo kilāso soso apamāro daddu kaṇḍu kacchu nakhasā vitacchikā lohitaṃ pittaṃ madhumeho aṃsā piḷakā bhagandalā pittasamuṭṭhānā ābādhā semhasamuṭṭhānā ābādhā vātasamuṭṭhānā ābādhā sannipātikā ābādhā utupariṇāmajā ābādhā visamaparihārajā ābādhā opakkamikā ābādhā kammavipākajā ābādhā sītaṃ uṇhaṃ jighacchā pipāsā uccāro passāvo’ti. Iti imasmim kāye ādīnavānupassī viharati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, ādīnavasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of danger? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, reflects in this way: ‘This body has much suffering and many dangers. For many kinds of diseases arise in this body, namely: eye-disease, ear-disease, nose-disease, tongue-disease, body-disease, headache, earache, mouth-disease, tooth-disease, lip-disease, cough, asthma, running nose, burning sensation, fever, stomach-disease, fainting, dysentery, gripes, cholera, leprosy, boils, eczema, tuberculosis, epilepsy, ringworm, itch, scabies, nail-scab, scab, blood-disease, diabetes, hemorrhoids, pustules, fistulas; illnesses arising from bile, illnesses arising from phlegm, illnesses arising from wind, illnesses arising from a conflict of humors, illnesses produced by change of climate, illnesses produced by careless behavior, illnesses produced by external assaults, illnesses arising as the result of past kamma; and cold, heat, hunger, thirst, defecation, and urination.’ In this way, he lives observing danger in this body. This, Ānanda, is called the perception of danger.

Katamā cānanda, pahānasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu uppannaṃ kāmavitakkaṃ nādhivāseti, pajahati, vinodeti, byantīkaroti, anabhāvaṃ gameti. Uppannaṃ byāpādavittakkaṃ nādhivāseti, pajahati, vinodeti, byantīkaroti, anabhāvaṃ gameti. Uppannaṃ vihiṃsāvitakkaṃ nādhivāseti, pajahati, vinodeti, byantīkaroti, anabhāvaṃ gameti. Uppannuppanne pāpake akusale dhamme nādhivāseti, pajahati, vinodeti, byantīkaroti, anabhāvaṃ gameti. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, pahānasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of abandoning? Here, Ānanda, a monk does not tolerate an arisen sensual thought (*kāmavitakka*); he abandons it, dispels it, destroys it, and brings it to an end. He does not tolerate an arisen thought of ill-will (*byāpādavittakka*); he abandons it, dispels it, destroys it, and brings it to an end. He does not tolerate an arisen thought of harmfulness (*vihiṃsāvitakka*); he abandons it, dispels it, destroys it, and brings it to an end. He does not tolerate whatever evil, unwholesome qualities (*akusaladhamma*) arise; he abandons them, dispels them, destroys them, and brings them to an end. This, Ānanda, is called the perception of abandoning.

Katamā cānanda, virāgasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā
rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā iti paṭisañcikkhati: ‘etaṃ santaṃ etaṃ
paṇītaṃ yadidaṃ sabbasaṅkhārasamatho sabbūpadhippaṭinissaggo taṇhākkhayo
virāgo nibbāna’ti. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, virāgasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of dispassion? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, reflects in this way: ‘This is peaceful, this is sublime: namely, the calming of all conditioned formations (*saṅkhārasamatha*), the relinquishing of all attachments (*upadhipaṭinissagga*), the destruction of craving (*taṇhākkhaya*), dispassion (*virāga*), and liberation (*nibbāna*).’ This, Ānanda, is called the perception of dispassion.

Katamā cānanda, nirodhasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā
rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā iti paṭisañcikkhati: ‘etaṃ santaṃ etaṃ
paṇītaṃ yadidaṃ sabbasaṅkhārasamatho sabbūpadhippaṭinissaggo taṇhākkhayo
nirodho nibbāna’ti. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, nirodhasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of cessation? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, reflects in this way: ‘This is peaceful, this is sublime: namely, the calming of all conditioned formations (*saṅkhārasamatha*), the relinquishing of all attachments (*upadhipaṭinissagga*), the destruction of craving (*taṇhākkhaya*), cessation (*nirodha*), and liberation (*nibbāna*).’ This, Ānanda, is called the perception of cessation.

Katamā cānanda, sabbaloke anabhiratasaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu ye loke
upādānā cetaso adhiṭṭhānābhinivesānusayā, te pajahanto viharati anupādiyanto.
Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, sabbaloke anabhiratasaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of non-attachment to the entire world? Here, Ānanda, a monk lives by abandoning and not clinging to the mental attachments, clingings, decisions, dogmas, and deep-seated latent tendencies (*anusaya*) that exist in the world. This, Ānanda, is called the perception of non-attachment to the entire world.

Katamā cānanda, sabbasaṅkhāresu anicchāsaññā? Idhānanda, bhikkhu
sabbasaṅkhāresu aṭṭiyati harāyati jigucchati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda,
sabbasaṅkhāresu anicchāsaññā.

And what, Ānanda, is the perception of unsatisfactoriness in all conditioned formations? Here, Ānanda, a monk is shocked, humiliated, and disgusted by all conditioned formations (*saṅkhāra*). This, Ānanda, is called the perception of unsatisfactoriness in all conditioned formations.

Katamā cānanda, ānāpānassati? Idhānanda, bhikkhu araññagato vā
rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā nisīdati pallaṅkaṃ ābhujitvā ujum kāyaṃ
paṇidhāya parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā. So satova assasati satova passasati.

Dīghaṃ vā assasanto 'dīghaṃ assasāmi'ti pajānāti. Dīghaṃ vā passasanto 'dīghaṃ passasāmi'ti pajānāti. Rassaṃ vā assasanto 'rassaṃ assasāmi'ti pajānāti. Rassaṃ vā passasanto 'rassaṃ passasāmi'ti pajānāti. 'Sabbakāyapaṭisaṃvedī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Sabbakāyapaṭisaṃvedī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ passasissāmi'ti sikkhati.

And what, Ānanda, is mindfulness of breathing? Here, Ānanda, a monk who has gone to the forest, to the foot of a tree, or to an empty room, sits down, cross-legged, holding his body erect, and establishing mindfulness at the fore. Ever mindful, he breathes in; mindful, he breathes out. Breathing in long, he understands: 'I am breathing in long.' Breathing out long, he understands: 'I am breathing out long.' Breathing in short, he understands: 'I am breathing in short.' Breathing out short, he understands: 'I am breathing out short.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in experiencing the entire body.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out experiencing the entire body.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in calming the bodily conditioning.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out calming the bodily conditioning.'

'Pītipaṭisaṃvedī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Pītipaṭisaṃvedī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Sukhapāṭisaṃvedī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Sukhapāṭisaṃvedī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Cittasaṅkhārapaṭisaṃvedī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Cittasaṅkhārapaṭisaṃvedī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Passambhayaṃ cittasaṅkhāraṃ assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Passambhayaṃ cittasaṅkhāraṃ passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Cittapaṭisaṃvedī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Cittapaṭisaṃvedī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. Abhippamodayaṃ cittaṃ ...pe... samādahāṃ cittaṃ ...pe... vimocayaṃ cittaṃ ...pe... aniccānupassī ...pe... virāgānupassī ...pe... nirodhānupassī ...pe... 'paṭinissaggānupassī assasissāmi'ti sikkhati. 'Paṭinissaggānupassī passasissāmi'ti sikkhati. Ayaṃ vuccatānanda, ānāpānassati.

He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in experiencing joy.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out experiencing joy.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in experiencing happiness.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out experiencing happiness.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in experiencing the mental conditioning.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out experiencing the mental conditioning.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in calming the mental conditioning.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out calming the mental conditioning.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in experiencing the mind.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out experiencing the mind.' Gladdening the mind ... and so on ... Concentrating the mind ... and so on ... Liberating the mind ... and so on ... Observing impermanence ... and so on ... Observing dispassion ... and so on ... Observing cessation ... and so on ... He trains himself: 'I shall breathe in observing relinquishment.' He trains himself: 'I shall breathe out observing relinquishment.' This, Ānanda, is called mindfulness of breathing.

Sace kho tvaṃ, ānanda, girimānandassa bhikkhuno imā dasa saññā bhāseyyāsi, ṭhānaṃ kho panetaṃ vijjati yaṃ girimānandassa bhikkhuno imā dasa saññā sutvā so ābādhō ṭhānaso paṭippassambheyyā”ti.

“If you, Ānanda, were to speak to the monk Girimānanda about these ten perceptions, it is possible that upon hearing these ten perceptions, his illness would immediately subside.”

Atha kho āyasmā ānando bhagavato santike imā dasa saññā uggahetvā yenāyasmā girimānando tenupasaṅkami; upasaṅkamtvā āyasmato girimānandassa imā dasa saññā abhāsi. Atha kho āyasmato girimānandassa dasa saññā sutvā so ābādhō ṭhānaso paṭippassambhi. Vuṭṭhahi cāyasmā girimānando tamhā ābādhā. Tathā pahīno ca panāyasmato girimānandassa so ābādhō ahoṣīti.

Then the Venerable Ānanda, having learned these ten perceptions from the Blessed One, went to the Venerable Girimānanda. When he arrived, he spoke to the Venerable Girimānanda about these ten perceptions. When the Venerable Girimānanda heard these ten perceptions, his illness immediately subsided. And the Venerable Girimānanda recovered from that illness. In this way, the Venerable Girimānanda was cured of his illness.

Dasamaṃ.

The tenth.

Sacittavaggo paṭhamo.

The chapter on One's Own Mind, the first.

Tassuddānaṃ

Its summary:

Sacittaṅca sāriputta, ṭhiti ca samathena ca; Parihāno ca dve saññā, mūlā pabbajitaṃ girīti.

One's own mind, and Sāriputta, standing, and with tranquility; decline, and two perceptions, roots, a renunciant, and Girimānanda.

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
saññā	saññā	perception	Girimānanda Sutta	The aggregate of recognition, label, and evaluation of sensory input.
anicca	anicca	impermanent	Girimānanda Sutta	The transient, arising-and-passing nature of all physical and mental phenomena.
anatta	anatta	non-self	Girimānanda Sutta	The core characteristic of all phenomena being empty of a permanent, unchanging self or ego.
rūpa	rūpa	physical form	Girimānanda Sutta	The material aggregate of existence.
vedanā	vedanā	sensation	Girimānanda Sutta	The aggregate of experiencing bodily sensations.
saṅkhāra	saṅkhāra	mental reaction	Girimānanda Sutta	The aggregate of conditioning, reaction, and volitional formation.
viññāṇa	viññāṇa	consciousness	Girimānanda Sutta	The aggregate of bare cognition

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				or awareness of a sensory object.
āyatana	āyatana	sense field	Girimānanda Sutta	The internal/external spheres of sensory and mental contact.
upādāna	upādāna	clinging	Girimānanda Sutta	The intense attachment to sensory objects or views.
virāga	virāga	dispassion	Girimānanda Sutta	The fading away of desires and attachment.
nirodha	nirodha	cessation	Girimānanda Sutta	The cessation of suffering and conditioning.
nibbāna	nibbāna	liberation	Girimānanda Sutta	The ultimate state of liberation, the unconditioned.
ānāpānasati	ānāpānasati	mindfulness of breathing	Girimānanda Sutta	The meditation practice of observing the natural breath.
anusaya	anusaya	latent tendency	Girimānanda Sutta	Deep-seated habitual patterns or reactions dormant in the deep mind.